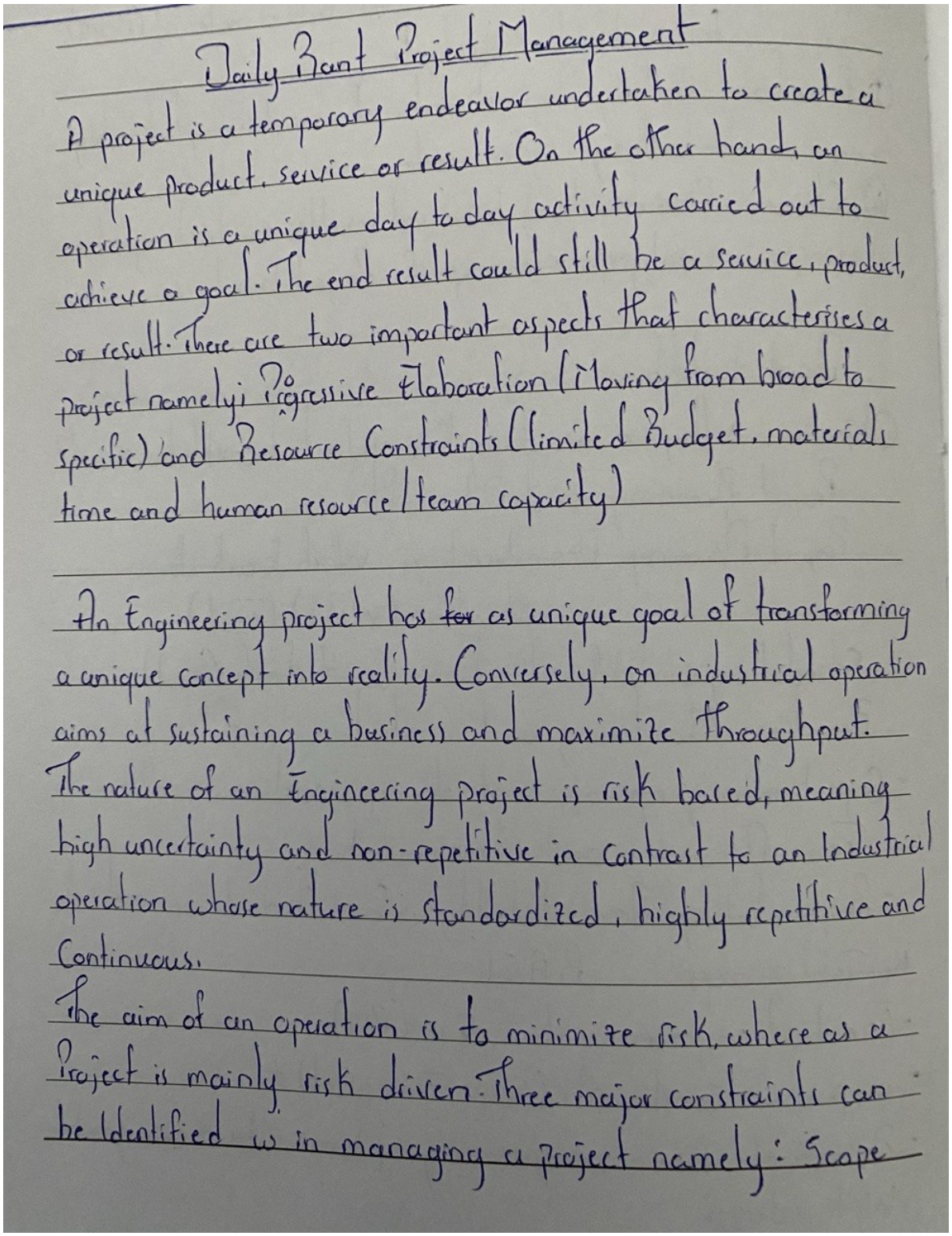
Project Management

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Daily Rant Project Management

A project is a temporary endeavor undertaken to create a unique product, service or result. On the other hand, an operation is a unique day to day activity carried out to achieve a goal. The end result could still be a service, product, or result. There are two important aspects that characterises a project namely; Progressive Elaboration (Moving from broad to specific) and Resource Constraints (Limited Budget, materials time and human resource/team capacity)

An Engineering project has as unique goal of transforming a unique concept into reality. Conversely, an industrial operation aims at sustaining a business and maximize throughput. The nature of an Engineering project is risk based, meaning high uncertainty and non-repetitive in contrast to an Industrial operation whose nature is standardized, highly repetitive and Continuous.

The aim of an operation is to minimize risk, where as a Project is mainly risk driven. Three major constraints can be Identified w in managing a project namely: Scope

(what are we building?), Time (when must it be completed?) and Cost (what are the available resources?). These constraints are heavily interelated and require balancing in order to properly manage a project.

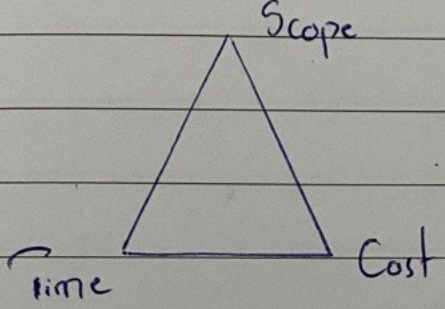


Fig: The Tripple Constraints: Balancing Scope, Time and cost.

$$\text{Project Management} = \frac{\text{Planning} + \text{Execution}}{\text{Time} + \text{Resources}} \quad \ldots (1)$$

Projet $\neq$ Routine Operation ... (2)